

EYES IN THE AIR A soldier operates a surveillance drone during a drill at the Line of Control in Kashmir

DEFENCE | **UAVs**

THE ENEMY WITHIN OUR DRONES

AS MILITARY DRONES ARE COMPROMISED BY ROGUE ELEMENTS FROM DEEP WITHIN THE CHINA SUPPLY CHAIN, INDIA MUST DEVELOP VIGOROUS CHECKS TO CONTROL CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY IN ITS OWN EXPANDING FLEET

By **Pradip R. Sagar**

Last month, military security experts in the United Kingdom were shocked to discover that cameras in the Royal Navy's K3 Scout unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) were sending periodic signals to a China-based internet address. The drones, built by a London-based company and inducted earlier this year, were reportedly being prepared for deployment in the Persian Gulf. The anomaly was detected during a cybersecurity assessment, not at the procurement or certification stage.